Celestual: The Turnaround Memo

Oct 13, 2026 · @Ace

The verdict

Celestual as it stands doesn't work, and no feature or ambassador will fix it.

- About 300,000 views produced 145 sign-ups and 90 letters, half of them from four accounts.
- 54 people sealed a note. Only 16 of those notes were aimed at someone also on Celestual, and none became a mutual that wasn't set up in advance.
- Two-thirds of the hearts on the wall (129 of 197) were added by code, and the business has made one $2.99 sale.

The cause is arithmetic, not marketing. A mutual needs both people on the app at the same time, and strangers from a viral video almost never are. So Celestual stops being an app people keep and becomes one night a group runs for itself: **"[group]'s 11:11"**. Everyone in the room knows each other. Signed thank-yous always arrive, and sealed picks open privately at 11:11 pm only when both people chose the same one.

What to do, in this order

Until discharge (about April 2027) this is a $0 test, not a launch.

1. **Get a private lawyer's answer** on whether you may run the company at all while serving. Don't ask through your unit unless the lawyer says to.
2. **Pay the trust debts this week.** Remove the invented hearts, hide the team's 45 letters, and lock the public table that logs who looked up whom. One screenshot of any of them ends any campus plan.
3. **Find a host (a club officer who will run a night for their group) who commits in writing,** before more than 10 hours of code. Start with Korean student associations and co-ed clubs, aiming at Pepero Day (11.11), the first pilot's hook. At least one of the first three nights should be a non-Korean group, or the test only proves the format for Korean associations. The US calendar follows: the last day of classes, "2.14 at 11:11", formal week, and the senior "last 11:11" in May.
4. **Only then build the 11:11, version 0:** names only, three kinds of pick, a private reveal, about 28 to 40 of your own hours with Claude writing the code.

5. **Judge every result against pass-or-stop tests ("gates") written now** and held by someone outside the team:
    - whether nights run from Korea through hosts work (Gate 1), ten days after the third night
    - romance at Gate 2, on 1 March 2027
    - "is the format real?" in June 2027
    - "is it a company?" in December 2027, after a term in person

Expect November to be small. There are about even odds it shrinks to one pilot on 20 November.

A good night of about 45 people gives roughly 100 thank-yous, 5 to 15 "closer friends" pairs and 0 to 2 "i like you" pairs. One night says nothing about romance. That needs about 650 "i like you" picks, likely from more than 1,100 people. So 1 March will probably read "not proven yet", and that is not a failure.

Your questions, in a line each

- **Why did 300,000 views become about 45 letters?** The videos sold a feeling with no action attached, asked viewers to try something they knew would fail, took seven steps to reach a ping, and couldn't be measured.
- **Does Celestual stay an app?** No. It becomes a night a group opens: a page reached by one DM, used for one week around one 11:11. Never a native app.
- **How do the features change?** Kill what fakes engagement, freeze the wall and the always-on note, and build only the group 11:11. The table is under "Product".
- **Is the mutual ping capped by density?** Yes, permanently, at global scale: 55 sealed notes from real users, only 16 aimed at someone on Celestual, and no mutual that friends didn't set up in advance. You can't lift the cap, so you shrink the world to one group and one night.
- **Is the wall just the Unsent Project?** Yes, a far smaller one: about 45 organic letters against their millions. Clean it, keep it as a quiet front porch, and stop building on it.
- **Should you hire sorority or community-college ambassadors?** No, paid or unpaid.
    - Celestual already ran a recruiting program and retired it with four rows of data.
    - Community colleges lack the dense groups this needs.
    - Sororities can host in spring through their councils, never as paid promoters.

Ambition, honestly

No plan lifts the cap in six months, because the cap is that two people must be in one place at one time. So the ambition goes into a high bar for December 2027 (40 or more groups running nights, half of them with no founder help) and the in-person launch in 2027, not into spending now.

If the gates pass, the big version is real: groups that rebook every term, campus-wide 11:11s, Korea's own calendar of confession days (Pepero Day, White Day), and a fall 2027 push with the founders on the ground. Even then, the odds of a durable company are roughly 1 in 10 to 1 in 20.

The 300,000 people who watched a film about an ex are not this plan's customer, and that's fine.

A further branch, a physical keepsake for couples instead of the group night, is weighed against the 11:11 in Branch: the keepsake.

The short version of that branch: the keepsake is the likelier business, but its advantage, revenue, is exactly what a serving founder may be barred from until April. So its core idea, two sealed letters that open together at 11:11, is tested first for free, after Gate 0. The object is sold only once a lawyer says yes, or after discharge.

Diagnosis: the marketing worked, the product can't convert it

The content did its job: it found people with something unsaid. Growth is capped because those people land in two products that can't pay off for them, and nothing they do brings in the next person.

What the production database says (13 October 2026):

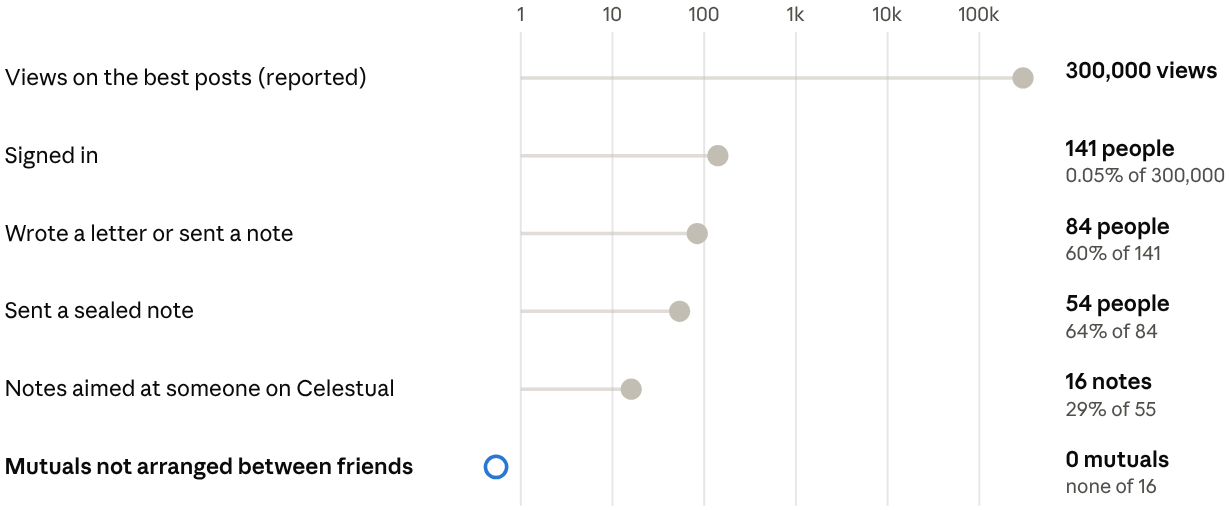
- **145 people** have signed in since 30 July; 98 proved an Instagram handle, 6 a school address.
- **90 letters, 79 live.** Four accounts wrote 45 of them (17, 14, 9 and 5), in bursts that read like the team seeding the wall. Everyone else, 39 people, wrote 45 (40 live), mostly in the two weeks after the late-September content.
- **72 pings from 56 people.** Only 16 of the 55 standing notes from real users (29%) point at someone who is on Celestual at all.
- **11 mutuals ever, between 19 people.** In 9 of them one side had joined within a day of the match, and 4 involve one of those four accounts. They were set up between friends. The organic mutual rate is about zero. The reveals on 3 and 10 October

produced none.

- **One purchase, $2.99.** 17 people were active in the last seven days.
- **Nothing measures a view becoming a visit.** Web analytics is not enabled, and every letter's source reads `direct`.

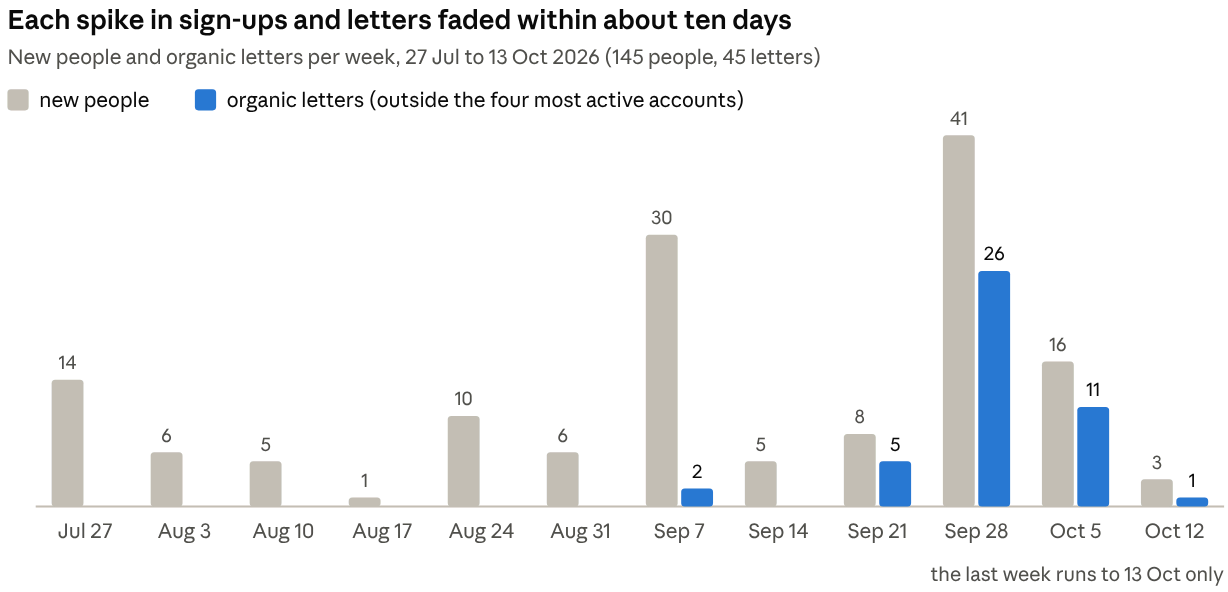
300,000 views became 141 people and zero unarranged mutuals

Count at each step on a log scale; the right column is each step as a share of the one before



Celestual production database, 13 Oct 2026; views as reported by the founders; the four most active accounts excluded

The loss happens at both ends. Almost nobody who watched came. The few who came mostly wrote to people who will never be here, so nothing could ever open.



Celestual production database, weeks starting Monday; organic letters exclude the 45 written by the four most active accounts

Both spikes followed a push (the Berkeley launch week, then the late-September content) and were gone within two weeks. Between pushes the product gains about five people a week and almost no letters.

Six reasons growth is capped

1. **Two products with opposite physics.** The wall is single-player and works at zero users: you write to someone and feel lighter. The ping is two-player and works only when both people are present at the same moment.
   - The wall's writers are mostly writing to exes, people who moved away, and in one case someone who died. Those are the people least likely to ever be on Celestual and send one back.
   - So the wall's demand is piped into the one product it can never pay off. Only 9 of the 43 people who ever wrote a letter placed a ping.
2. **The ping is capped by density, and the weekly reveal cut it further.** A mutual needs three things to be true at once: you're both on Celestual in the same window, they feel it too, and they name you (formula below). With 145 people spread across several countries, the first of those is close to zero for almost everyone.
   - Since 27 September a note runs only to the next Saturday, and keeping it alive costs a ping. Two people who both care must now act within the same week or so, instead of within 60 days.

    - Shrinking a note's life from 60 days to about a week cuts the chance that both notes are live at once by roughly eight times. The match record can't show it yet, because nearly every mutual so far was arranged between friends.
3. **The wall is the Unsent Project without the archive.** The Unsent Project's draw is volume: so many letters that you can search your own name and find one. Celestual has 79, and half of those came from four accounts. At catharsis, the job both products do, Celestual is strictly worse at this size.
    - Its one real difference, that a letter here could actually be answered, is not used anywhere in the product.
4. **The content delivered the feeling instead of the action.** A film or skit about unsent love gives the viewer the catharsis inside the video, so watching is the whole experience.
    - The ask that followed was a test most viewers know will fail. Asked "do they still think about you?", most think of someone who isn't on this app.
    - The path was long: video, profile, link, the wall in Instagram's browser, write, then a DM code to ping, then wait for Saturday. There was no deadline and no reason to act today.
    - The result: about 0.05% of views became a person, and about 0.015% an organic letter.
5. **Nothing brings the next person.** Nothing a writer or sender does is designed to pull in someone else, and the open-door Story card from the growth framework was never built. Each spike in the chart above decays to near zero in about ten days, so every new person is bought with founder content effort.
6. **Craft has outrun evidence.** 77 migrations, a council, nine gates, a logo lab and a 35-second film, for 145 people and 17 weekly actives. In two weeks the posture changed on campus scope, open letters, replies, sharing, money and the reveal schedule, with no measurement to judge any of it.

The chance that one note becomes a mutual:

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P(\text{mutual}) = P(\text{they are here in the same window}) \times
P(\text{they feel it too}) \times P(\text{they name you})
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The product can't change the second term. All of growth strategy is the first term, and the plan below attacks it with time rather than headcount.

What did work, and must be kept: a strong emotional hook (300k views), people writing deeply and sincerely in five languages, and a privacy design that makes the honest version of this product possible.

The user: who actually shows up, and what they want

The people Celestual attracts mostly want to say something to someone who is gone. The people who can make a mutual happen want to know about someone who is still here. The product serves the first group's feeling and needs the second group's behaviour.

Who writes (shares of the 40 live letters from the 39 people outside those four accounts):

Segment	Share of organic letters	What they write	Their person	Can their note become a mutual?	Role in the plan
The Mourner	58% (23)	an ex, an apology, "come back", "do you still think of me"	gone: another city, another relationship, sometimes dead	almost never: the person is not in their world any more	audience, content supply, the reason people watch
The Hopeful	15% (6)	a crush, a situationship, "do I have a chance?"	here: same school, club or friend group	yes, and they are the only segment that produces mutuals	the engine; small today, must become the target
The Appreciator	10% (4)	gratitude, a friend's inside joke, "you light up the room"	here, and they want them to see it	partly: they want the letter found, not sealed	the vector: letters people want the subject to find
Noise	12% (5)	jokes, tests, a single emoji	none	no	moderation load
Grief	5% (2)	someone who died	gone	no	handle with care; never marketing material

Those shares come from reading each of those letters; the categories are judgment calls. Two more groups never write and outnumber everyone above. **Readers** are the 24 people who left hearts, and the much larger number who read and left. **Searchers** came to look for their own name and left when it wasn't there. Nobody measures either.

The psychology that matters

- **The real question is "do they think about me?", not "how do I confess?"** It is the question the founders' own film ends on. The product forbids answering it unless the other person independently asks too, which for a Mourner means never.
- **Fear of rejection beats desire, until a deadline arrives.** Removing all risk also removes all urgency: if nothing bad happens by waiting, people wait. Every proven format in this space has a deadline: graduation, Valentine's Day, the end of a survey window.
- **The feeling is episodic and triggered by moments.** Anniversaries, holidays, seeing their Story, the end of a semester, New Year's Eve. Celestual has no moments, only a weekly clock that runs on Pacific time.
- **Sharing has to make the sharer look desired, never needy.** Nobody posts "I wrote to someone". People will post "I'm open to hearing it", and they will send a friend "is this about you?"

Where they are

- **They arrive from Instagram,** inside its in-app browser, which is also where magic-link sign-in breaks (the mail opens in another browser).
- **They are global and diaspora-heavy.** 71 of 90 letters carry no campus. The letters mention Berkeley, USC, New York and Busan, and are written in English, Korean, Mandarin pinyin, Turkish, Spanish and French.
- **The Berkeley push didn't take.** 19 letters carry Berkeley, but only 3 came from outside the four most active accounts. It also produced 6 school-address proofs and one logged card scan.
- **The founders are in Korea.** Any plan that needs them standing on a US campus before 2027 fails on contact.

The implication: the audience is global and the mechanic is local. The plan has to manufacture local density inside a global audience, by gathering people into the same moment and the same small groups.

Framing: does Celestual stay an app?

No. Celestual stops being an always-on app and becomes a ritual a group runs for itself, delivered as a link. Everything that works in this category sits in the same corner of the map.

Mutual reveals work when a group and a date bound them

Products placed by who can take part and when it happens; positions show the type, not a measurement



market map · who can take part against when it happens; comparables from section 9

Celestual today sits where reveals go quiet: anyone can join, at any time, so the person you'd pick is almost never there. The move is diagonal, and it needs both halves: a group whose members know each other, and one night.

Every direction considered, and the verdict

Nine directions were argued over three rounds of review by independent critics. Only one survived as the main bet.

Direction	Verdict	The deciding reason
Keep the global, always-on app and market harder	**No**	No organic mutual has ever happened. More views buy another ten-day spike.

Direction	Verdict	The deciding reason
A global event night, such as 31 December	**No**	A 3,000-stranger night opens 2 to 17 two-way notes in total, and draws people chasing exes at an hour when nobody is awake at the desk.
Relaunch on one campus (Berkeley)	**Not until the founders can stand on it**	The Berkeley push produced 3 organic letters; the earlier campus windows never had a way in.
Compete with the Unsent Project as an archive	**No**	79 letters against 5 million; keep it only as the fallback pivot (a letters media brand).
"Someone likes you, pay to find out who"	**Never**	It is the Gas and NGL shape: spikes, then the FTC.
Korea first (Everytime, campus clubs, White Day)	**Not yet: a memo by 31 January, and an optional in-person night only if the lawyer allows it**	It splits a small team, and Korean consent and age-check rules differ. White Day (14 March 2027) is the natural test if November works.
A reconciliation tool for any two people	**Folded in, not separate**	It becomes the "sorry" kind inside a group's night in version 1.
A native app	**Never**	A night needs a link and a DM, not an install.
A group's own night: "[group]'s 11:11"	**Yes, as the main bet**	It is the only format with both a boundary and a deadline, the shape every working comparable shares. It runs from Korea through hosts, and it can be tested for almost no money.

What Celestual is, in one line: a one-night ritual a group runs for itself, where the things people never said to each other open at 11:11 pm, only when they go both ways.

It is not a dating app, not a confession page and not a feed. The wall stays as the brand's quiet front porch, and the always-on note keeps running for the few who use it, but neither is the business.

Product: keep the engine, stop faking, build one thing

Keep the privacy engine and the proof of identity. Kill everything that invents engagement or waits for global density. Build exactly one new thing: a group's 11:11 night.

Your two questions, answered

Is the mutual ping capped by density? Yes, permanently, at global scale. Of 55 sealed notes from real users, 16 point at someone who is on Celestual, and none has ever opened without being arranged between friends.

- No amount of content fixes this. A New Year's night for 3,000 strangers would open somewhere between 2 and 17 two-way notes in total.
- Inside a group where everyone knows everyone, the same mechanic gives a 45-person night about 100 thank-yous, 5 to 15 two-way "closer friends" pairs and 0 to 2 romantic ones.
- Even then, a small group produces some mutuals by pure chance. So the plan judges romance only against a chance baseline, and only after about 650 "i like you" picks.

Is the wall just the Unsent Project? Yes, a smaller and partly invented one. It has 79 letters against their 5 million, half written by four accounts. About two-thirds of the hearts it shows were never pressed: 129 invented against 68 real (migration 0059 adds them on purpose).

Its honest job from now on is a quiet front porch and a mood board for the brand, kept clean and never shown to a host as "the product".

Feature by feature

Feature	Today	Verdict	Why
Invented hearts (`hearts_seed`)	129 of the 197 hearts on live letters	**Kill today**	It is fake engagement, the exact theory the FTC used against NGL. One screenshot ends any campus plan.
Letters written by the team	45 of 90	**Hide** for now, don't delete, until you confirm who wrote them; bring back only real ones, labelled	It is the same problem, in words.
Addressee faces pulled from Instagram	on every @-letter	**Kill**	It exposes people who never joined, some possibly minors.
`zz_archive_handle_lookups`	readable with the public key	**Lock, record, drop today**	It is a plaintext log of who looked up whom, the one thing the hashing design exists to prevent.
Stripe checkout and pings by the week ($2.99)	one purchase	**Turn off, refund the one purchase**	It is a trust tax with no revenue, and possibly not legal while in service (see Money).

Feature	Today	Verdict	Why
Weekly Saturday reveal (Pacific time)	no organic mutual	**Leave it running, stop promoting it**	Retiring it is real work and touches the privacy design; leaving it costs nothing and keeps the published promises true.
Sealed note to any @	55 notes standing	**Freeze**	It can't resolve at global density, and new notes should not be encouraged.
The wall's letters	40 live organic	**Freeze in maintenance mode**	They are catharsis, not growth. First-name letters, search and real hearts stay.
Replies under letters	2 replies in three weeks	**Freeze; switch off if the desk is busy**	Unused, extra desk load, and the founders' own gate once ruled them out.
Colours, the Cal network mark, intro film, logo lab, reel	built	**Freeze**	Craft before evidence. Reuse the pixel-phone look for the 11:11 screens.
"Someone wrote about you" email (opt-in)	11 sign-ups	**Keep**	It is consented and true.
Instagram DM proof	98 people proved by DM	**Keep and repurpose**	It becomes the one-step join: DM a keyword, get a single-use link.

Feature	Today	Verdict	Why
Google sign-in	2 people	**Hide inside Instagram's browser**	It fails there, which is where people arrive.
School-email proof	6 people	**Keep as the fallback join**	It is needed when Instagram fails on the night.
Moderation and the desk	working	**Keep; add a crisis path**	When a writer's words signal self-harm, show resources and hold the letter.
Third-party analytics	none	**Don't add; log first-party events instead**	The privacy policy promises no third-party analytics.
A native app	none	**Never**	A night needs a link, not an install.

The one thing to build: 11:11, version 0

One page per group night, at an unguessable address, kept fully separate from the existing ping engine and its Instagram automations.

- **Join.** Each night has its own secret keyword or link, posted only in the group's chat, never on a card, sticker or public post. DM it to @celestual.us and get a single-use link tied to your Instagram account. Confirm a birth month and year (18 or older), type a first name and last initial, and give an email for the 11:11 pm result, with that purpose stated on the screen.
  - Anyone who joins without the night's own link waits in a one-tap approval queue for the host or the operator (the host's second officer, who helps run the night).
  - A join never triggers the old automations: no mutual news, no tags, just a plain reply.
- **Pick.** Names only, no text, in three kinds:
  1. *thanks*: signed, up to 10, always delivered
  2. *closer friends*: sealed, up to 3
  3. *i like you*: sealed, up to 2

- **Open.** A sealed pick opens only if both people chose the same kind for each other, and the pick screen says so: "it opens only if they picked the same one. pick the one you mean." Picks can be changed or withdrawn until 10:11 pm. Results appear at 11:11 pm local, privately, on the page and by a neutral email, never by DM.
- **Everyone opens something.** Officers split the joined list so every member receives at least one real, signed thank-you from an officer before 10:11 pm; officers may send up to 40 on their own night. The page never shows a bare zero.
- **Who can see what.** Members see the directory, never picks. A member can silently mute someone, which also blocks that person's thank-yous; removing someone is left to the operator. The host and operator see counts only. The pick screen says plainly that the two founders could technically read picks until deletion, and every read is logged.
- **After.** At 71 hours a job saves the aggregate numbers the gates need; at 72 hours picks that went one way are deleted. Two-way pairs keep their names for 14 days (for "did you talk?"), then become anonymous, and are deleted at Gate 2. The result page asks: tell me about the next one; do it again?; did you know?
- **Run.** The founders create each night. The operator gets a key that works for that one night only and does two things: pause the reveal, or remove someone. Nobody in a participating group ever gets the Instagram inbox or the desk. Reports go through a form to a named responder outside the group who is awake during the reveal; no responder, no night. Host terms bar any group event or alcohol at reveal time and say honestly when reports are read. Rosters are reported as a count, never a screenshot of names.
- **Size.** About 50 to 70 engineering hours, or 28 to 40 founder hours with Claude writing the code, including the join. None of it starts until a host has committed in writing; before that, only a clickable demo.

Version 1 comes only after Gate 1 passes. It adds one line each after a mutual (moderated), a letter to the whole group, "sorry" and "formal?" kinds, and picks that can stand until the group's next night.

Design, brand and content: keep the look, change the promise

Keep the name and the pixel-phone look. Change what they promise: not "find out if they still think about you", which almost never comes true, but one specific night that does: "[group]'s 11:11".

The positioning, in one breath: for people in a close group who have something they've never said to someone in it, a Celestual 11:11 is a one-night ritual. Everyone sends sealed notes to people in the group, and at 11:11 that night the ones that went both ways open, for those two only. Unlike a confession page, nothing is ever posted. Unlike a crush app, it's for anything unsaid, and nobody learns they were chosen unless they chose back.

The words

Say	Instead of	Why
"[group]'s 11:11"	"Night", "event", "launch"	11:11 is when people make a wish, and 11.11 is Pepero Day. The time never changes and the date does: "2.14 at 11:11", "the last 11:11" for seniors. It also suits a name about the sky. It isn't Korean: Pepero Day is only the first pilot's hook, and any close group can run one.
"pick them. if they picked you the same way, it opens at 11:11 pm. if not, they're never told."	"find out if it's mutual", "nobody ever knows"	It is exactly true under same-kind matching, and has no product jargon in it.
"it's mutual." on the reveal screen only	"mutual" in any acquisition copy	On Instagram, "mutuals" means followers.
"private", "sealed"	"anonymous" in anything a host sees	Risk chairs read "anonymous" as Yik Yak.
thanks · closer friends · i like you (for Korean groups only: 고마워요 · 친해지고 싶어요 · 좋아해요)	"crush", "ping", "dating"	Lead with the unsaid, never with "crush".

The name

Keep Celestual for now; renaming costs months and there is no evidence yet that the name is the problem. Set a trigger instead. If 3 or more of the first 10 hosts misspell it or ask whether it's an astrology app, rename before April. Until then the host's name and "11:11" do the talking, and every link is tapped or scanned, never typed.

Design rules for 11:11

- **Reuse the pixel phone.** The group's short name sits in the carrier slot where "CAL" sits now, the clock reads 11:11, and there is one lit key: "count me in". At most 45 words above the fold.
- **A hard budget.** No new colours, glyphs or type sizes, and at most three new screens: the landing, the directory with picks, and the result.
- **A plain front door for hosts.** Host and risk-chair material is a one-page document, not the phone. Hosts land on a plain `/host` page, never on the wall. The 11:11 page never links to the wall, the paywall or any face.
- **Design the empty result first.** Most people will open no two-way pick. They see the thank-yous they received (officers make sure there is at least one), then "nothing opened both ways this time. that's how most people's night goes." Never a bare zero.

Content: what to stop, and its one job now

Stop selling exes and grief ("do they still think about you?"), which recruits the people least likely to ever match. Also stop cinematic films, brand-only posts, "find out if it's mutual", "search your name", anything seeded or invented (films included), and filming anyone's reveal.

Content's only job until Gate 1 is host leads, at no more than 3 founder hours a week:

- archive the old grid of letters to exes, and set the bio to "a private 11:11 for your group. nothing is ever posted."
- three pinned posts: what an 11:11 is, what nobody ever sees, and run one for your group
- one post a week at most: the format, or a gratitude letter whose writer opted in, ending "comment HOST"; a bilingual Pepero Day explainer for Korean student associations
- after each night, an honest recap with true counts above the floors and a quote from the host

Measure it as at least one HOST lead per 10,000 views, and at least 5 qualified host calls from content by 3 November. The film and the aesthetic aren't wasted. They become the senior "last 11:11" campaign in May, once there are real nights to show.

Growth: hosts, not ads

Stop buying attention for a product that can't convert it. From now on, growth comes one host at a time, and each host brings a whole group's members into the same night. That is the only kind of growth that raises the odds that both people are on Celestual at the same time.

Why the UGC, films and skits didn't convert

They worked as entertainment and failed as a funnel, for four reasons:

1. **The video was the payoff.** It delivered the catharsis itself.
2. **The ask was a test most viewers knew would fail.** Their person isn't on the app.
3. **There was no deadline and no group.** Nobody had a reason to act today, together.
4. **There was no measurement.** Nobody could tell which post worked.

More of the same, or better versions of it, buys another spike that is gone in ten days.

Your ambassador idea: sororities and community colleges

Not now, and not as paid ambassadors. Celestual has already tried this twice and its own migrations record the result:

- The recruitment competition (migration 0016) was retired in 0034 with four rows of data in total.
- The campus windows (0006) were retired in 0035 with their tables empty, because they never had a way in.

Paying people to promote a product with no loop and no night produces exactly the "mid launch" you're afraid of.

Group	Verdict	Why
Sororities	**Spring 2027, through councils, never paid per head**	They are the right shape: dense, Instagram-native, with formal season where "would you go with me?" is a real fear. They are the wrong ask in November. A single-gender chapter can't make mutuals unless a paired fraternity joins too. Chapters run new-member periods into November, and risk chairs veto anything that sounds like an anonymous crush app. Paid reps read as MLM to their own sisters.
Community colleges	**No**	Commuter, part-time students with little shared social life: the worst shape for a product that needs everyone in the same room. A community-college student with a big following is a creator deal, not an ambassador.
Korean student associations, co-ed K-pop, dance and cultural clubs	**Yes, first, in November**	Mixed-gender, dense, Instagram-native, with a guaranteed weekly meeting and no national office to veto. They already celebrate 11.11 as Pepero Day, and the founders' own network reaches them.
Campus crush or confession pages	**Never as hosts**	They are pile-on machines with no roster and no boundary.

The host engine

1. **Census first (by Fri 16 Oct).** Each founder lists named people they know in US Korean student associations and co-ed clubs: the org, its active roster, and the relationship. Until the lawyer answers, these are personal soundings only: no company materials, no written commitments.
2. **Pitch their ritual, not your app.** "We'll run a private 11:11 for your Pepero Day." Only if the lawyer clears paying and buying (Branch B, see Money below), add: "and we'll buy from your Pepero sale", a fixed quantity at their price, whatever the turnout. Someone not in service places the order, and their post carries a sponsorship line. The packs carry no join path, go to members at the group's own event and never to public tables, and the first call with the host checks the school's rules on outside sponsorship.
3. **Cold outreach waits for the right moment.** 300 officer emails from campus organisation directories go out 1 to 15 December and 15 January to 5 February, aimed at incoming boards for the Valentine's wave. In October they would only reach boards about to turn over, and eat the build week.
4. **Two contacts per host, and a standby host for every date.** Hosts ghost; that is the most common failure.
5. **The in-room moment is the whole night.** In the first five minutes of the group's meeting, everyone joins with the night's own keyword, posted only in the group chat, and sends one signed thank-you. Sealed picks are made later, alone. The review panel's estimate: a push in the group chat alone gets 10 to 15% of members; five minutes in the room gets 40 to 60%.
6. **End every night by booking the next one.** The host announces the next date in the group chat, and every result page asks whether you're in another group that should run one. Rebooking and spreading are the two numbers that decide whether this is a company.

The group card does the posting, not individuals. "[group]'s 11:11 · send a thank-you to anyone in [group]; it opens at 11:11 pm. you can also pick 'closer friends' or 'i like you'. those open only if they picked you the same way. if not, they're never told. the link is in the group chat." The host posts it from their own account, which is herd cover by design: being in says nothing about who you picked. Use "11.11 at 11:11" for the event, not the PEPERO trademark. No individual "I'm in" cards in version 0.

Money: earn nothing, spend almost nothing, ask the lawyer first

Celestual should take no money until a Korean lawyer says in writing what the founders may do while in service. After that, revenue waits for proof that groups come back.

Why the $2.99 pings can't work

- **There is nothing to buy yet.** One purchase in two weeks, and zero organic mutuals for a ping to pay for.
- **Each buyer pays about once.** Since 29 September a bought ping that doesn't open comes back as credit, so a buyer rarely needs to buy again.
- **It sells the wrong thing.** Extra guesses for curious people is the "pay to find out" shape that NGL's paid hints were punished for.
- **It may not be legal for the founders.** Korea's Framework Act on Military Status and Service (Article 30) restricts profit-making activity by serving soldiers. That is a personal risk to the founders, and a sale has already happened. This document is not legal advice, which is why the first step is a lawyer.

The legal question: a private lawyer first, written answer by Wed 21 Oct

Ask a lawyer privately: the free Korea Legal Aid Corporation (대한법률구조공단), or a paid consult of about $50 to $150, budgeted outside the $0 rule. Contact your unit or the Military Manpower Administration (병무청) only if the lawyer tells you to. An inquiry through the chain of command puts possible profit-making on record before you have counsel.

Ask whether a serving founder may:

1. own or manage the US company, and keep building unpaid
2. pay a US contractor
3. pay or donate to a student organisation
4. buy goods, such as Pepero, for a group's event
5. receive any revenue
6. appear in or narrate content
7. attend a student event in Korea in person

Also ask how each answer changes by type of service (active duty, 사회복무요원, 산업기능요원), and whether funding the US company from Korea needs an overseas direct investment report (해외직접투자 신고).

Today, separately: ask a US accountant which year the LLC was formed. A foreign-owned single-member LLC files Form 5472 with a pro-forma 1120 for each year it has reportable transactions. For 2025 that was due 15 April 2026, or 15 October 2026 with an extension. The penalty is $25,000 per form.

Three branches, decided on 21 October

	Branch 0: barred	Branch A: the default	Branch B: only with a written yes and 3 named hosts
When	The lawyer says you may not run it, or need permission first	No answer, or a partial no	A written yes on paying and buying, and three named hosts with dates
The company	Dormant: Stripe closed, the $2.99 refunded, no spending, no outreach, content or operations under its name	Runs, unpaid	Runs
Who runs a night	Only a non-serving US person, with the lawyer's sign-off; otherwise trust fixes and in-person preparation until permission or discharge	The host plus a volunteer operator (the host's second officer), who holds a per-night key and nothing else	The host plus one US-time producer, 20 to 25 hours a week (about $3,000 to $3,400 in total), bound by written confidentiality
What the host's group gets	Nothing	The night itself and a thank-you	A fixed purchase from their own Pepero sale, or pizza, up to $250, delivered whatever the turnout, and disclosed
Cash through 7 Dec	$0	$0, plus the lawyer	Up to $5,000
Cash through 1 Mar 2027	$0	$0	Up to $7,000 in total

	Branch 0: barred	Branch A: the default	Branch B: only with a written yes and 3 named hosts
Email	None	Free tier, so at most one night a day	Paid tier, about $20 a month

Under no branch do the founders raise money, hire more than one person, pay anyone per participant or per result, or give anyone in a participating group the Instagram inbox. Paying per head inflates the very participation number the gates read, and it rewards leaning on new members.

Where money could come from later, not before June 2027

Source	Who pays	What it is based on	When to test it
Organisations paying for their night	senior class councils, Greek councils, large associations	Datamatch's free dates are funded by student-government grants of $4,000 to $5,000	priced letters of intent, January to February 2027
Sponsors	local restaurants (free dates); a snack brand on Pepero Day	the same Datamatch model	after the first nights have real numbers
A digital keepsake for two-way pairs	the two people, both consenting	the review panel's only real willingness to pay, about $2 to $3	version 1
Letters as media	readers, through Patreon and books	PostSecret, which is ad-free and funded this way	only from public letters whose writers opted in

The honest ceiling: unless groups rebook and start hosting without founder help, this is a seasonal tradition worth a few hundred dollars a night. That would make it a side project, not a company. The June 2027 bar in the plan makes that call in advance, so nobody has to make it in a hopeful mood.

The bigger picture: what worked for everyone else

Every product that made a mutual reveal work put it inside a bounded group and a date. Every one that went global and always-on either faded, sold for talent, or met the FTC. Celestual has been building the second kind.

Product	What it is	Reported scale	Boundary and timing	What happened	Lesson for Celestual
Marriage Pact (2017)	annual campus survey; everyone gets one match	750,000 participants, 112 campuses (own site)	one campus, one annual window	$5M seed in 2022 (Stanford Daily); free to students	a boundary, a date and a guaranteed payoff can scale
Datamatch (1994)	Valentine's matching, romantic or platonic	40+ schools, 8,200+ students in 2026	campus, 14 February	student-run; free dates paid by student-government grants (Crimson)	run by students, funded by sponsors
Dartmouth Last Chances, Yale Last Chance Dance	seniors name crushes; mutual names revealed before graduation	not published	one class, graduation	a yearly tradition at several schools since at least 2003	the closest twin of Celestual's mechanic, and it works because of the boundary and the deadline
Facebook Secret Crush (2019)	up to 9 friends; told "someone has a crush on you"	all of Facebook	friends list, always on	called creepy (BuzzFeed News); no usage ever reported	infinite density was not enough without a moment
Gas (2022)	anonymous compliment polls by school; $6.99 a week to see hints	1M daily users in two months	school, always on	sold to Discord in January 2023, shut in November 2023	"someone picked you" spikes and dies
tbh (2017)	the same idea, a year earlier	5M downloads in 9 weeks	school, always on	bought by Facebook, shut for low usage in July 2018	the same

Product	What it is	Reported scale	Boundary and timing	What happened	Lesson for Celestual
NGL (2021)	anonymous questions through Instagram Story links	15M installs by July 2022	followers, always on	FTC and Los Angeles order in 2024: $5M, banned from serving under-18s, for fake messages and paid "hints"	the line Celestual must never cross
The Unsent Project (2015)	unsent texts to first loves, searchable by name	5M+ submissions	global, always on	viral on TikTok when people searched their own names (Yahoo)	a catharsis archive wins on volume, and Celestual can't out-archive it
PostSecret (2004)	anonymous secrets on postcards	500,000 to 1M postcards, 6 books	global, always on	ad-free, paid by Patreon and books; its 2011 app was pulled after four months because moderating it became unmanageable (WTOP)	a letters media brand is real but small, and anonymous apps die of moderation
Everytime (Korea)	anonymous campus boards	7M sign-ups, 397 campuses	campus, always on	the default campus layer in Korea	Korea's anonymous campus space is already owned

These source pages could not be opened from this environment; the figures come from search-result excerpts gathered on 13 October 2026. Check them before quoting them outside the founders.

What Celestual could become

Looked at from far enough away, Celestual's real asset is not the wall. It is a trustworthy way for two people to find out they both want the same thing, without either one going first.

1. **Nights for groups (now to May 2027).** One night, one group, sealed notes that open only if they go both ways.

2. **Nights for every awkward ask (2027).** The same mechanic for formal and date-party invitations, closer friendships, "I'm sorry, I'd talk if you would", roommates and project partners. These are categories where reciprocity is much higher than for crushes, so more people get a yes.
3. **The mutual layer for communities (2028 and later).** Clubs, alumni groups and associations run their own nights without founder contact, and pay or are sponsored to.
4. **The letters, as culture, alongside all of it.** A small media brand of the unsaid, from consented public letters only: books, exhibits, a yearly report with strict floors.

What it should never become: a "someone likes you, pay to find out who" app (the Gas and NGL shape), a dating app, or a feed.

The plan: calibrate now, launch in person

Until the founders are discharged, Celestual does not launch. It runs a cheap, honest experiment whose gates are written down before anyone sees a result. Every gate has a pass, a fallback and a stop, so the decision is made now, while nobody is hoping.

This week, before a single outreach message

What Claude can do tonight (paste this list into a session), all due `Oct 15, 2026`:

- [ ] Pull the Supabase API and Postgres logs for any read of `zz_archive_handle_lookups` before they expire, and write down what they show, so the lawyer can judge any duty to notify people (Korea's PIPA Article 34; GDPR Articles 33 and 34 if any users are in the EU) and the privacy page can be corrected. Then lock the table and drop it, and add a daily check for public tables without row-level security.
- [ ] Set the invented hearts to zero and drop the column. Post: "on 25 Sep we added hearts nobody pressed to the letters on the wall at the time. we've removed them; every count is now real." Keep a sealed copy of the old values in the incident record.
- [ ] Hide, don't delete, the 45 letters from the four most active accounts.
- [ ] Turn off the face scraper, empty the cached faces and make the avatars private.
- [ ] Turn off Stripe checkout and the paywall.
- [ ] Add a crisis path: a letter whose words signal self-harm shows help resources and waits for the desk.
- [ ] Add the 18+ birth-month screen to wall letters and global notes; a failed screen sticks to that Instagram account.

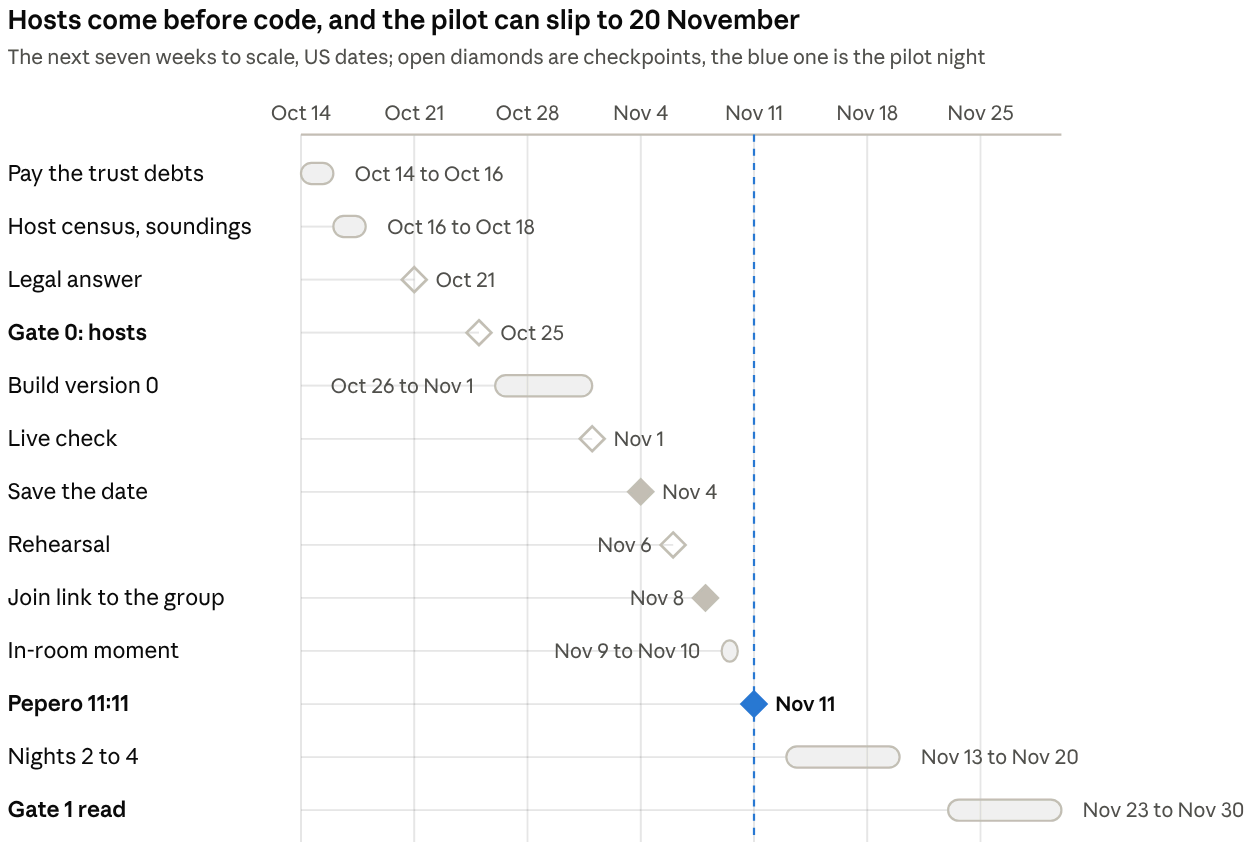
- [ ] Build a clickable demo of the 11:11 for host conversations, and nothing more. At most 10 hours of code go in before a host commits in writing.

What only you can do:

- [ ] Ask a US accountant whether the LLC's Form 5472 was filed. Due Oct 15, 2026
- [ ] Book the private lawyer. Written answer due Oct 21, 2026
- [ ] Refund the one $2.99 purchase. Email the writers of the 21 letters that showed invented hearts, where you have a contact. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] Archive the Instagram grid of letters to exes and change the bio. Audit every post since 30 July for padded counts or team letters shown as real. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] Name the outside gatekeeper. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] Write the host census and an honest hours grid; say who owns hosts and who wrote the 45 letters. Talk to at most ten named officers, as personal soundings, until the lawyer answers. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] Draft the host one-pager, the terms and the 60-second room script. Draft a privacy addendum too: it must correct today's published promises ("no list of who is on the service", "the only message naming another person is the mutual", "no marketing mail", "matching runs on salted hashes", the Apify lookups, who has access, and "we run celestual from the United States"; the next-11:11 opt-in also needs an unsubscribe link and a postal address) before any night link goes live. Due Oct 18, 2026

The standing rule from today: no invented letters, hearts, counts, participants or notes, anywhere, including films. It goes into the host and creator terms.

The next six weeks



plan calendar, US dates; reveals at 11:11 pm local, which is the next afternoon in Korea

At most 10 founder hours of code go in before Gate 0 (a host committed in writing, by 25 October): enough for a clickable demo a group's officers can vote on. If no host commits, that is all that was spent.

On 4 November the host posts only a save-the-date. The join link goes into the group chat after the rehearsal's go on 8 November, so a failed rehearsal never cancels anything in front of a real group. Any missed checkpoint moves the pilot to Friday 20 November automatically, without a meeting.

The gates

The gate sheet is frozen on Thursday 5 November and held by the outside gatekeeper. Nobody amends a threshold after that.

This matters because pre-set "no"s have been overridden before: letter sharing on 23 September, the alert email on 25 September, and the invented hearts. Every gate below has an outcome for every possible result, so no result can be argued into a pass.

Gate	When	Go	Otherwise	Stop
Legal	Wed 21 Oct	A written yes on paying and buying: Branch B becomes possible	A partial no that still allows running it unpaid: Branch A, $0. No answer: Branch A, $0, and the pilot can at best move to 20 Nov	Barred, or permission needed: Branch 0
Gate 0: hosts	Sun 25 Oct, 21:00 KST	A host committed in writing to a room moment on 9 or 10 Nov and the reveal on 11 Nov (active roster of 60 or more, two contacts), 3 hosts dated by 20 Nov, and counsel permits: pilot on 11 Nov	Any other case with at least one written host: nights from 20 Nov, which report results but decide nothing	No host, or Branch 0: no nights in 2026
Live check	Sun 1 Nov	Joining and picking work in production, and 3 hosts are committed	The pilot moves to Fri 20 Nov	

Gate	When	Go	Otherwise	Stop
Rehearsal	Fri 6 Nov, decided Sun 8 Nov	80% of 20 to 30 testers join within 5 minutes; no rate-limit errors; the reveal is on time; the result link works for 90%. Testers use their own existing accounts that have never messaged @celestual.us, never new ones. The rehearsal must also prove that DMs arriving in the message-request folder reach the system without anyone accepting them, and the 71-hour snapshot runs on it. Then the join link goes to the group chat	The pilot moves to Fri 20 Nov with the same hosts	

Gate	When	Go	Otherwise	Stop
Gate 1: does remote hosting work?	10 days after the third night has run	All of: 3 nights with 25 or more joined each; a median of 35% of the active roster joined (50% of those in the room); 60% of joiners send a pick beyond the scripted thank-you, and 40% a sealed one; 40% opt in to the next 11:11; half of respondents say "do it again" (with 30% responding); no more than 10% receive zero thank-yous; no unresolved serious incident; and, once 3 hosts are eligible, half rebook within 21 days, counting only dates announced in the group chat	Fewer than 3 nights by 7 Dec: incomplete, never a kill; remote hosting stops for lack of hosts only if fewer than 3 commit for February by 5 Feb. Any other result: one extension of up to 2 more nights, re-read 14 days after the last; anything short of a pass then is a stop	Median participation under 25%, or "do it again" under 35%, or an unresolved serious incident: remote hosting stops, and in person becomes the next test
Gate 2: does the romance work?	Mon 1 Mar 2027	650 or more clean "i like you" picks, 10 or more clean pairs, at least 1.5 times chance, and statistically significant, all surviving the removal of timing-flagged pairs	Anything else reads "not proven yet": no romance-led marketing or fundraising, and nights continue on thanks and closer friends	650 or more picks at 1.2 times chance or less: the romantic layer comes off

Gate	When	Go	Otherwise	Stop
June 2027: is the format real?	June 2027	Judged on rates: participation, groups booking again without being pitched, the share of nights groups ran with no founder help, and the romance verdict		
December 2027: is it a company?	Mon 13 Dec 2027, after the first term in person	40 or more groups have run a night, half of them with no founder help; 40% ran two or more; a quarter of new hosts first took part elsewhere; one campus-wide senior 11:11 with 30% of seniors taking part		Below the bar: Celestual is a side project, said out loud

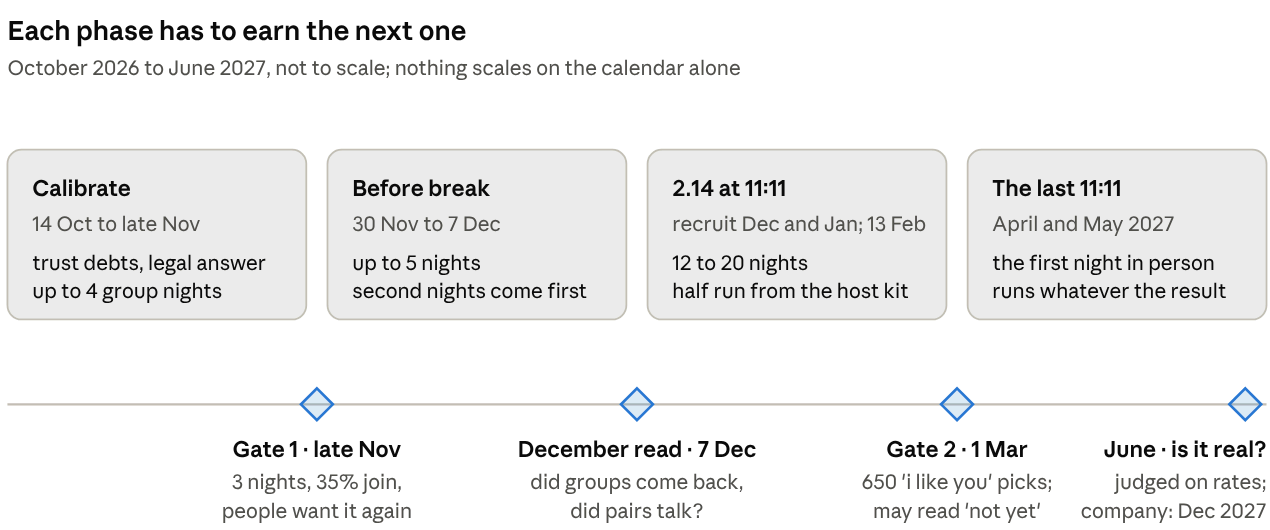
Nights continue past 1 March (Gate 2 as a whole passes) when the romance verdict is a pass or "not proven yet", half the groups whose first night was at least 60 days earlier ran a second night or announced its date in their group chat, and half the February nights ran without a founder call.

Keeping the count honest.

- **"Chance" means something precise.** It is the number of pairs you'd get by shuffling everyone's picks at random within their own night, keeping how many each person sent and received. It is computed over 10,000 shuffles, then doubled, because there is no gender field and most romantic picks cross genders. Without the doubling, chance alone would pass the gate about 9 times in 10. So only co-ed nights count toward the romance verdict; single-gender nights, and nights where the host switched "i like you" off, are reported separately.

- **Mutuals that don't count.** Never counted: mutuals among the founders, the producer, host officers, the four most active accounts, the 19 people in past mutuals, and anyone who joined through a test link. Also excluded: pairs where one side joined through the other's personal link, and pairs who tap "we planned this" or "already together" (no answer counts as not clean).
- **Timing flags.** Pairs who picked within three minutes of each other on the same network are flagged and reported both ways.
- **The analysis is tested before it is trusted.** The gatekeeper reviews the 71-hour snapshot before the sheet is frozen. By 31 January the analysis is run on two fakes: a 500-person room with no real feelings must fail, and the 11 old arranged mutuals must be caught.

After November



roadmap · four phases and four gates, October 2026 to June 2027

- **December** is for second nights with the pilot groups, which is the frequency test, plus at most three new groups running from the kit.
- **February** scales to 12 to 20 nights only if Gate 1 passed.
- **From 1 March to 15 May** any group that asks can run its own night with no cap and no call, if Gate 1 passed and no incident is open.
- **The first in-person night after discharge runs whatever the remote result.** Only Branch 0 or an incident pause stops it. In person is the version the plan calls the real launch, and it has to be tested before anyone decides the company's fate.

- **Korea:** write a one-page memo by 31 January covering White Day (14 March 2027), consent and age checks under Korean law. An optional in-person control night in Korea this November is worth running only if the lawyer allows it (question 7), a co-ed club with 40 or more members commits, and Korean screens and a Korean privacy notice exist. It is reported separately and never counts toward Gate 1.

Hours, and the one-person version

The repository shows one human committer (52 of 380 commits, the rest written with Claude) and 8 commits since 1 October. The two-founder plan needs 80 to 104 hours by 8 November, which one person in service can't supply. So the one-person version is the realistic default, in this order:

1. Trust fixes: Claude, one evening.
2. The lawyer.
3. Soundings with ten or fewer named officers.
4. Nothing else until one host commits in writing.
5. Then Claude builds version 0.
6. At most one night in November.
7. Cold outreach in December and January.

When hours run short, cut in this order: content, cold outreach, the Korea night, the analysis code, version 1. Never cut the trust fixes, the lawyer or the gates.

If there really are two founders with time, this is the split:

Workstream	Owner	Hours to 8 Nov
Trust fixes, legal and admin	product founder	7 to 9
Documents: pitch, terms, script, privacy addendum	operations founder	5 to 7
11:11 version 0, including the join	product founder, with Claude writing the code	28 to 40
Testing and the rehearsal	both	8 to 10
Host conversations	operations founder	18 to 24
Content, for host leads only	operations founder	up to 10

Workstream	Owner	Hours to 8 Nov
Coordination	both	4

Either way there are never more than three workstreams at once. Nothing else gets built until Gate 1: no logos, films, colours or wall features.

The debates: the case against this plan, and the calls only you can make

This is a disciplined bet, not a sure thing. These are the strongest objections the reviewers raised, the answers, and what remains true after the answers.

The objection	The answer	What remains
"We asked to be saved, and you're giving us four nights with student clubs."	Saving Celestual means finding out cheaply whether anyone wants it badly enough to come back. Four nights answer that for almost no money, before you bet discharge, savings or a raise on it.	If November fails, the honest answer may be that Celestual is a project, not a company.
"Events spike and die. BeReal faded, Gas faded."	That is why the gates read rebooking, self-serve hosting and spread, not sign-ups. A group that runs a second night without being asked is the frequency signal.	A group may only want one to three nights a year. That ceiling is real.
"In a 45-person group, people match by chance. You'll fool yourselves."	The romance gate compares "i like you" pairs against what random picking would produce, needs about 650 "i like you" picks (more than 1,100 people), and is held by an outsider.	November can't prove the romance, and 1 March will probably say "not proven yet".

The objection	The answer	What remains
"Every working comparable was run by insiders on campus. You're in Korea."	Gate 0 and Gate 1 test remote hosting for about $0. If they fail, in person becomes the next test, and the first in-person night runs whatever the remote result.	This is the most likely way the plan fails, and the founders' network decides it.
"You're abandoning our audience: 300k views, people writing to their exes."	That audience never produced one unarranged mutual. The wall stays up and clean; the film and the look come back for the senior campaign in May.	The emotional heart of the brand, the unsent letter, is parked for now. Version 1 brings words back after a mutual.
"Thank-yous turn it into a compliment app like Gas."	They're signed, capped at 10, never counted publicly, and nothing is sold. Officers make sure every member gets at least one, so everyone who matches nobody still opens something real.	If thank-yous are all people want, that is a different, smaller product. Gate 2 will show it.
"Sponsoring Pepero is buying participation."	It is a fixed purchase from the group's own sale, delivered whatever the turnout, disclosed, ordered by someone not in service, and only under Branch B. The packs carry no way to join.	If the lawyer says no, there is no sponsorship at all.

Risks that stay open

Risk	How likely	Guardrail
The founders may not run the company at all while serving	unknown until 21 Oct	A private lawyer first, never the chain of command on your own. If barred, Branch 0: the company goes dormant. Possible personal consequences (discipline, extended service) are the reason this comes before everything.
No host commits by 25 October	real: the reviewers put the chance that no hosts come through at about 45%	Gate 0 caps the loss at 10 hours of code.
Instagram restricts @celestual.us on a night	low, high damage	School-email fallback join; the reveal lives on the page and in email; nobody in a participating group ever gets the inbox.
Someone gets hurt in a dense group: screenshots, pressure, a partner	possible	Private reveal, one-way picks never shown, same-kind matching, host terms, any serious incident pauses every night.
Minors	low, but enough to end it	Birth month and year screen, college groups only, an adult officer hosts, no public links.
Founder time	real: 372 commits in September, 8 so far in October	At most three workstreams, automatic slip dates, nothing new built outside the plan.
Overriding your own gates when a result disappoints	it has happened	The gate sheet is frozen on 5 Nov and held by someone outside the team.
A past US filing is overdue: Form 5472 for the LLC	unknown until an accountant checks	Ask today; the penalty is $25,000 per form.

Risk	How likely	Guardrail
Insider privacy: the founders, alumni of these groups, can technically read picks until deletion	certain	Picks are read only through a logged function, the pick screen says who could read them, and one-way picks are deleted at 72 hours.
Nobody is awake when a night opens: 11:11 pm in the US is the next afternoon in Korea, during duty hours	real	A named responder outside the group, awake for the reveal. No responder, no night.
The invented hearts become a story once disclosed	possible	Disclose plainly and first, keep the incident record, and never add a number that isn't real again.

The calls only you can make, this week

- [ ] Choose a $0 test until discharge (recommended) or a remote launch (only with a written legal yes and three named hosts). Due Oct 15, 2026
- [ ] Pay the trust debts, starting with the invented hearts, the 45 team letters and the open table. Due Oct 15, 2026
- [ ] Name the outside gatekeeper. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] Write the host census and an honest hours grid for each founder, and say who owns hosts. Due Oct 16, 2026
- [ ] Get the written answer from a private lawyer, not through your unit. Due Oct 21, 2026
- [ ] Decide, in advance, what you'll do if Gate 0 finds no host. The keepsake branch proposes the rule: no host means the free pair-letter test starts the next day; a host means the pilot runs first and the pair test follows. Write it down and give it to the gatekeeper. Due Oct 25, 2026

One more question to answer honestly, today: if the June 2027 bar is missed, do you want Celestual as a company, or as something you made? The plan works for either, but you have to know which one you're running.

How this plan was tested

The plan was argued against three times by independent critics before any of it was written here. Each round changed it.

Round	Who attacked it	Verdict	What changed
1	five critics: a consumer investor, a campus growth operator, a user panel, trust and safety, a contrarian	a global New Year's "Midnight" was the wrong flagship	The flagship moved from one global night to closed groups. The public "knock" on the wall was cut, and money was switched off.
2	eight reviewers: investor, operations, group insiders, safety and legal, engineering against this codebase, statistics, brand, a completeness critic; then a synthesis	every reviewer scored that draft 3 out of 10 (the completeness critic gave it 2)	Hosts come before code. $0 until a legal answer. The trust debts were found (the invented hearts, the open table). Gates were rebuilt against chance and held by an outsider. Version 0 became names-only, with the thank-you layer and the 11:11 name.

Round	Who attacked it	Verdict	What changed
3	five refuters: the founder reading it, the hosts and members, a statistician, a risk reviewer, an ambition critic; then a judge	scores 4 to 6 out of 10; seven fatal flaws, all confirmed; ready to hand over once they were fixed	Private counsel before the unit, and a Branch 0 for 'barred'. A slip can no longer trigger a false kill. The romance gate was rebuilt (it would have passed on chance) and needs 650 picks. A data snapshot comes before deletion. No public join key, and no inbox for volunteers. Every member gets a thank-you. The in-person night runs regardless. A one-person version, and this front page.

One claim from the last round was rejected rather than adopted: that switching to the weekly reveal cut matches from ten to one. The data shows those ten were arranged between friends, so it proves nothing either way.

Sources

- **Celestual production database** (Supabase project `celestual`), aggregate queries run on 13 and 14 October 2026; letter themes from reading the 40 live organic letters, nothing identifying reproduced.
- **The repository** `aceyeom/celestual`: README.md, docs/ULTIMATE-PRODUCT-FRAMEWORK.md, docs/PERSONAS.md, docs/WALL-FEATURES.md, docs/THE-COUNCIL.md, docs/PRICING-REVENUE.md, docs/PINGS-BY-THE-WEEK.md, docs/ONE-WALL.md, migrations 0006, 0016, 0034, 0035, 0059 and 0069, reel/DESIGN.md, and the commit history.
- **Comparables:** the links in the table under "The bigger picture". These pages could not be opened from this environment; their figures come from search-result excerpts gathered on 13 October 2026.

- **Models:** the expected-mutuals model and the gate simulations were written and run for this review; the gate thresholds come from those simulations, not from published research.